



A L O V E S K I N G U I D E

Know Your Skin. Love What You Put On It.

A field guide to every step in your routine, and every
skin type it's made for.

LoveSkin

THE COMPLETE SKINCARE GUIDE

What's Inside

Everything you need to build a routine that actually fits your skin.

PART ONE – YOUR ROUTINE, STEP BY STEP

01 Cleansers 5

Wash away dirt, oil, and sunscree...

02 Oil Cleansers 6

A first-cleanse step that melts aw...

03 Toners 7

A light, alcohol-free liquid that re...

04 Essences 8

A watery, lightweight layer applie...

05 Serums & Treatments 9

Concentrated formulas – vitamin...

06 Spot Treatments 10

A targeted, concentrated formula...

07 Eye Creams 11

Lightweight, targeted hydration f...

08 Moisturizers 12

Lock in hydration and support yo...

09 Facial Oils 13

An optional finishing layer that se...

10 SPF 14

Broad-spectrum sun protection –...

GETTING STARTED

How to Use This Guide 3

A quick note before you dive in

PART TWO – KNOW YOUR SKIN TYPE

Oily 16

Shiny most of the day and prone t...

Dry 17

Feels tight, flaky, or rough.

Combination 18

An oily T-zone with drier cheeks.

Normal 19

Fairly balanced and rarely irritated.

Sensitive 20

Reacts easily, with redness or sti...

CLOSING

About LoveSkin 21

Our approach, and a gentle remin...



SKINCARE, UNDERSTOOD FOR YOU.

How to Use This Guide

Ten steps. Five skin types. No pressure to use them all.

Skincare works best when it's simple enough to stick with. This guide walks through the ten product categories that make up a full AM/PM routine – in the order they're applied – followed by a closer look at the five skin types we design around.

You don't need every step on every page. Start with the essentials – cleanser, moisturizer, SPF – and layer in serums, treatments, and finishing touches as your skin and your routine evolve.

READING A PRODUCT PAGE

- How & When to Use – where it fits in your AM or PM routine.
- By Skin Type – how the formula or approach shifts for different skin.
- Common Mistakes – the easiest ways this step goes wrong.
- Quick FAQ – fast answers to the questions we hear most.

READING A SKIN TYPE PAGE

- Signs and Causes – how to recognize it, and why it happens.
- Look For and Avoid – ingredients and formulas worth seeking out or skipping.
- Common Mistakes and Quick FAQ – the details that trip people up.

A note: this guide offers general education, not medical advice. For persistent concerns, a dermatologist can always give you guidance tailored to you.



PART ONE

Your Routine, Step by Step

Ten product categories, in the order you'd apply them.

Cleansers

Wash away dirt, oil, and sunscreen without stripping your skin. The first step in every routine, morning and night.

01

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Use morning and night, massaging into damp skin for 30–60 seconds before rinsing with lukewarm water.

BY SKIN TYPE

Oily and combination skin do well with gel or foaming formulas. Dry and sensitive skin do better with cream or milk cleansers that don't strip.

Common Mistakes

- Washing more than twice a day
- Using hot water – it strips natural oils
- Choosing a formula that leaves skin feeling tight or “squeaky clean”

Quick FAQ

Do I need a different cleanser for morning and night?

Not necessarily – the same gentle cleanser can work for both, though some prefer a lighter rinse in the morning.

Should I double cleanse every night?

Only if you're wearing sunscreen or makeup; otherwise a single cleanse is enough.

Oil Cleansers

A first-cleanser step that melts away sunscreen and makeup before your regular cleanser goes to work.

02

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Use in the evening only, before your regular cleanser. Massage onto dry skin to dissolve sunscreen and makeup, then emulsify with water and rinse.

BY SKIN TYPE

All skin types benefit when wearing SPF or makeup – even oily skin, since oil dissolves oil more effectively than a water-based cleanser alone.

Common Mistakes

- Skipping it on sunscreen days
- Using it in the morning when it isn't needed

Quick FAQ

Will an oil cleanser make oily skin worse?

No – oil dissolves oil and rinses away without leaving residue.

Is this a step everyone needs?

Only if you wear sunscreen, makeup, or heavy products during the day.

Toners

A light, alcohol-free liquid that removes residue and preps skin to absorb the treatments that follow.

03

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply after cleansing, morning and night, patted or swept onto skin before serums and treatments.

BY SKIN TYPE

Oily and combination skin benefit from balancing, alcohol-free toners. Dry and sensitive skin should look for hydrating, essence-like formulas.

Common Mistakes

- Using alcohol-based toners that strip the skin barrier
- Treating toner as optional rather than a prep step

Quick FAQ

Is toner actually necessary?

Not essential, but it helps treatments absorb better and removes cleansing residue.

Can toner replace moisturizer?

No – toner preps skin but doesn't lock in hydration.

Essences

04

A watery, lightweight layer applied after toner that adds a boost of hydration and preps skin to absorb serums more effectively.

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply after toner and before serums, patting a few drops into skin morning and/or night – it absorbs quickly, no rubbing needed.

BY SKIN TYPE

Most worth adding for dullness (a hydrating essence boosts glow) or aging (a firming essence supports elasticity). Optional for other concerns.

Common Mistakes

- Treating it as a required step for every routine
- Applying too much
- Using it in place of toner instead of layering after one

Quick FAQ

Is an essence the same as a toner?

No – toner preps and removes residue, essence adds extra hydration and actives on top.

Do I need an essence in my routine?

It's optional – most worth adding for dullness or aging concerns.

Serums & Treatments

Concentrated formulas – vitamin C, retinol, niacinamide, and more – targeted at specific concerns like acne, dullness, or aging.

05

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply after toner and before moisturizer. Antioxidant serums like vitamin C work best in the morning; actives like retinol or AHA/BHA belong in the evening, usually starting 2–3 nights a week.

BY SKIN TYPE

Which serum matters most depends on your main concern – niacinamide for acne, vitamin C for dullness or dark spots, retinol for aging, azelaic acid for redness.

Common Mistakes

- Introducing multiple new actives at once
- Layering incompatible actives (retinol + AHA) on the same night
- Expecting results before 6–8 weeks

Quick FAQ

Can I use more than one serum?

Yes – layer thinnest to thickest, and avoid combining strong actives on the same night.

How fast do serums work?

Most actives take 4–8 weeks of consistent use to show results.

Spot Treatments

A targeted, concentrated formula applied directly to a specific problem area – like an active breakout or a stubborn dark spot – rather than all over the face.

06

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply a small amount directly onto the area of concern after your serum or treatment step, letting it absorb before moisturizer.

BY SKIN TYPE

Most useful for acne (benzoyl peroxide or sulfur for active breakouts) and dark spots (a concentrated brightening gel). Not needed without an isolated problem area.

Common Mistakes

- Applying all over the face instead of just the spot
- Layering with other strong actives on the same area
- Expecting overnight results

Quick FAQ

Can I use a spot treatment every day?

Yes, but only on the specific area that needs it.

Do I still need my regular serum?

Yes – a spot treatment targets one area only, not your whole complexion.

Eye Creams

Lightweight, targeted hydration for the delicate skin around the eyes.

07

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply morning and/or night with your ring finger, gently patting a small amount around the orbital bone – never dragging or rubbing.

BY SKIN TYPE

This area needs a lighter formula than the rest of the face – oil-free for acne-prone skin, richer for dryness, fragrance-free for sensitive skin.

Common Mistakes

- Applying too close to the lash line
- Rubbing instead of patting
- Using the same rich moisturizer meant for the rest of the face

Quick FAQ

Is eye cream necessary?

It's optional but helpful – the eye area is thinner and shows dehydration and fine lines first.

Can I just use my regular moisturizer instead?

You can, but a dedicated eye cream is formulated for the area's sensitivity.

Moisturizers

Lock in hydration and support your skin barrier. Formulated lighter for oily skin, richer for dry skin.

o8

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply as the last hydrating step morning and night, after serums and treatments, while skin is still slightly damp.

BY SKIN TYPE

Oily and combination skin do best with lightweight gels or lotions. Dry and sensitive skin need richer creams with ceramides.

Common Mistakes

- Skipping moisturizer on oily skin (it triggers more oil production)
- Using a rich cream that's too heavy for your skin type
- Applying to fully dry skin instead of slightly damp skin

Quick FAQ

Do I need a different moisturizer for morning and night?

Not required, though some prefer something lighter under SPF and richer at night.

Can oily skin skip moisturizer?

No – skipping it backfires and increases oil production.

Facial Oils

An optional finishing layer that seals in moisturizer and softens skin overnight.

09

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply as the very last step at night, after moisturizer, pressing a few drops into skin.

BY SKIN TYPE

A light layer works even for oily skin (like squalane). Dry and sensitive skin can use a slightly heavier, nourishing oil.

Common Mistakes

- Applying oil before moisturizer instead of after
- Using too much
- Treating it as required when it's optional

Quick FAQ

Is facial oil essential?

No – it's an optional finishing layer, most useful for dry or dehydrated skin.

Will facial oil cause breakouts?

A lightweight, non-comedogenic oil like squalane is safe for most skin types, including acne-prone.

SPF

Broad-spectrum sun protection – the single most impactful step for keeping your skin healthy long-term.

10

HOW & WHEN TO USE

Apply as the final morning step, every day regardless of weather or indoor plans, and reapply every 2 hours with prolonged sun exposure.

BY SKIN TYPE

Oily and combination skin do best with mattifying, oil-free formulas. Sensitive skin should look for mineral SPF with zinc oxide.

Common Mistakes

- Skipping SPF on cloudy or indoor days
- Applying too little product
- Skipping reapplication during extended exposure

Quick FAQ

Do I need SPF if I'm indoors all day?

Yes – UVA penetrates windows and contributes to aging.

Does makeup with SPF count?

Usually not enough on its own – wear a dedicated sunscreen underneath.



PART TWO

Know Your Skin Type

Five skin types, and how to care for each one.



Oily

Shiny most of the day and prone to enlarged pores.

Oily skin produces more sebum than it needs, which is why it looks shiny by midday and tends toward larger, more visible pores. The routine leans on lightweight, oil-free formulas that clear excess oil without stripping skin – stripping it only tells your skin to make more.

Signs to Look For

- Skin looks shiny by midday, especially through the T-zone
- Pores appear larger on the nose and cheeks
- Makeup or SPF slides off faster
- Breakouts and blackheads are more frequent

What Causes It

Overactive sebaceous glands – often genetic, and influenced by hormones, humidity, and over-stripping (which triggers more oil).

Look For

- Gel or foaming cleansers
- Oil-free, lightweight gel moisturizers
- Niacinamide
- Salicylic acid (BHA)
- Mattifying, oil-free SPF

Avoid

- Heavy, occlusive creams and butters
- Alcohol-based toners
- Skipping moisturizer to avoid shine

Common Mistakes

- Skipping moisturizer to avoid shine
- Over-washing or scrubbing
- Using heavy creams meant for dry skin

Quick FAQ

Does oily skin still need moisturizer?

Yes – skipping it triggers more oil. Use an oil-free gel instead.

Can oily skin use facial oil?

In small amounts, yes (like squalane) – it's optional, not essential.

Dry

Feels tight, flaky, or rough.

Dry skin doesn't produce enough natural oil to stay comfortable on its own, which is why it can feel tight right after cleansing or show visible flaking. The routine focuses on rich, barrier-supporting hydration layered on to ease tightness and lock in moisture.

Signs to Look For

- Tightness after cleansing
- Visible flaking or rough patches on the nose and cheeks
- Fine lines more noticeable when dehydrated
- Patchy makeup application

What Causes It

Produces less natural oil – genetic or age-related, and worsened by cold weather, hot showers, and harsh cleansers.

Look For

- Cream or milk cleansers (non-foaming)
- Hyaluronic acid
- Ceramides
- Rich cream moisturizers
- Nourishing facial oil

Avoid

- Foaming or sulfate cleansers
- Hot water
- Alcohol-based toners

Common Mistakes

- Washing with hot water
- A foaming cleanser that leaves skin "squeaky clean"
- Applying moisturizer to fully dry, not damp, skin

Quick FAQ

Does dry skin need to exfoliate?

Yes, gently – about 1–2 times a week.

Does dry skin still need SPF?

Yes – UV damage isn't tied to skin type.

Combination

An oily T-zone with drier cheeks.

Combination skin behaves differently across the face – an oilier T-zone (forehead, nose, chin) alongside cheeks that are normal or dry. The routine balances oil control with hydration, often by adjusting how much product goes where rather than picking one extreme.

Signs to Look For

- Shine concentrated in the T-zone by midday
- Cheeks normal or dry by comparison
- Larger pores down the center of the face
- Products that suit the T-zone feel heavy on the cheeks

What Causes It

Sebaceous glands are denser across the forehead, nose, and chin than across the cheeks.

Look For

- Balancing, gel-based moisturizers
- A gentle gel cleanser
- Niacinamide

Avoid

- One heavy product applied uniformly
- Building a routine entirely around one extreme

Common Mistakes

- Using the same product amount across the whole face
- Building a routine entirely around the oily or dry parts
- Over-treating the T-zone with actives strong enough to irritate the cheeks

Quick FAQ

Should I use two moisturizers?

Some do (a light gel on the T-zone, a richer cream on the cheeks), but one balancing lotion works for most.

Is this the same as oily skin?

No – combination skin has a genuinely drier zone that an oily-skin routine would over-dry.

Normal

Fairly balanced and rarely irritated.

Normal skin has a well-functioning barrier and balanced oil production, so it rarely feels shiny, tight, or reactive. The routine keeps things simple and consistent – maintenance rather than correction.

Signs to Look For

- Rarely shiny or tight
- Few breakouts, minimal sensitivity
- Barely noticeable pores
- Tolerates most new products well

What Causes It

Naturally well-functioning oil glands and a strong skin barrier.

Look For

- A gentle, pH-balanced everyday cleanser
- A lightweight moisturizer that adjusts with the seasons
- Daily SPF

Avoid

- Overcomplicating with unnecessary actives
- Skipping SPF because skin behaves well

Common Mistakes

- Assuming “normal” means no maintenance and skipping SPF
- Using richer or stronger products “just in case”
- Not adjusting the routine as seasons or environments change

Quick FAQ

Does normal skin still need a full routine?

Yes – a simple one: cleanser, moisturizer, SPF.

Can normal skin become oily or dry over time?

Yes – it can shift with age, hormones, or climate.

Sensitive

Reacts easily, with redness or stinging.

Sensitive skin reacts more easily than other types – to new products, fragrance, weather changes, or certain active ingredients. The routine prioritizes fragrance-free, barrier-supporting products and introduces anything new slowly.

Signs to Look For

- Stinging or burning with new products
- Visible redness or flushing
- Reacts to fragrance or certain actives
- Reactive to weather or temperature changes

What Causes It

A compromised or naturally thinner skin barrier; can be linked to rosacea, eczema, or a genetic tendency.

Look For

- Fragrance-free formulas
- Ceramides
- Centella asiatica or other calming ingredients
- Azelaic acid
- Mineral SPF (zinc oxide) over chemical sunscreens

Avoid

- Fragranced products
- Alcohol-based toners
- Layering multiple actives at once
- Physical scrubs

Common Mistakes

- Introducing too many new products at once
- Skipping patch testing
- Using harsh physical exfoliants instead of gentler chemical options

Quick FAQ

How should I patch test?

Apply to your inner arm or jawline and wait 48 hours before using it on your face.

Can sensitive skin use retinol?

Sometimes, gently – start low and slow, or consider azelaic acid instead.



A CLOSING NOTE

Thank You for Spending Time on Your Skin

LoveSkin doesn't believe skincare needs to be complicated, or that more products always mean better results. We built this guide the same way we build every routine: by matching real skin to the categories and habits that actually help it.

Skin changes with seasons, hormones, and time – and it's worth revisiting your routine as it does. Keep this book on your shelf, or by your mirror, and come back to it whenever your skin needs a second look.

Routines and information in this guide are for general education only, and aren't a substitute for advice from a dermatologist.

LoveSkin

Skincare, understood for you.